Pune Vidyarthi Griha's College of Engineering, Technology and Management, Pune

S.Y. B. Tech (AI & DS)

WORKPLACE BEHAVIOUR [MB333A]

UNIT I - DETAILED MODEL ANSWERS (15 x 5 Marks)

Course Outcome: CO1: Apply management and workplace Behaviour concepts to individual and group

Academic basis: Prepared as an original academic synthesis using the prescribed textbooks/reference books listed at the end. Each answer contains explanation, application, a practical example, a diagram, extended discussion and exam-oriented points, and is designed to occupy at least about 1.5 A4 pages.

Diagram instruction: Every model answer includes a relevant labelled diagram/flowchart. Students should reproduce the diagram neatly with arrows and labels; equivalent conceptually correct diagrams may be accepted.

Q1. Apply the concept of Workplace Behaviour to a workplace situation covering its scope and importance in an organization.

Real-life workplace scenario: A workplace manager examines individual, group and organizational factors before selecting an intervention, instead of assuming that poor performance is caused by attitude alone.

Model Answer

Workplace Behaviour is the systematic study and practical application of knowledge about how people behave as individuals and in groups within organizations. Its purpose is not merely to describe behaviour; it helps managers understand, anticipate and influence workplace outcomes in a responsible manner.

Key explanation / application:

- **Individual level:** Personality, perception, attitudes, values, learning, motivation and individual differences influence how an employee interprets work and responds.
- **Group level:** Roles, norms, communication, leadership, power, conflict, cooperation and team processes influence collective behaviour.
- **Organizational level:** Structure, policies, culture, technology, work design and managerial systems create the wider context in which individuals and groups operate.
- **Outcomes:** Typical outcomes include performance, job satisfaction, engagement, attendance, teamwork, quality, innovation, conflict and employee well-being.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: collect evidence at all three levels, identify the factors that are actually influencing behaviour, and choose interventions that match the cause. For low motivation, this may mean feedback and recognition; for team conflict, role clarification and communication; for organizational confusion, clearer policies and priorities.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A newly formed project team is missing milestones. At the individual level, one member may lack confidence in a new tool; at the group level, roles may be unclear and communication irregular; at the organizational level, priorities may change frequently. A manager who applies Workplace Behaviour concepts can address training, role clarity, meeting norms and priority communication rather than attributing the problem to 'poor attitude' alone.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

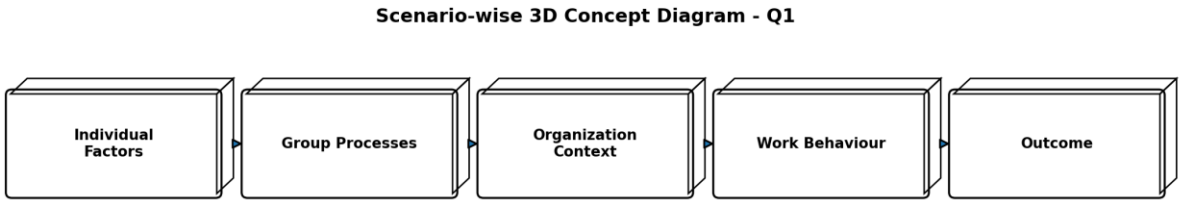


Figure Q1: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Outcome

Individual Factors	Group Processes	Organizational Context	Work Behaviour	Performance & Satisfaction

Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organizational Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Extended discussion: Workplace Behaviour is multidisciplinary. It draws on psychology for individual processes, social psychology and sociology for group processes, and management theory for organizational systems. Its practical strength is the ability to connect these levels. A performance problem that appears to be an individual issue may actually be caused by unclear team roles or an organizational policy. Conversely, a broad organizational problem may sometimes be improved through individual coaching or skill development. Managers should therefore diagnose before intervening and should distinguish observable facts from assumptions about employees.

Additional mini-case: A new employee misses two deadlines. Instead of immediately labelling the employee as careless, the manager checks the work process and finds that the employee did not receive access to a required system and was unsure whom to contact. Providing access, role clarity and a peer mentor solves the problem. This illustrates why individual, group and organizational factors should be considered together.

Exam-writing point: A strong answer should move from concept to level-wise application and then to workplace outcomes such as performance, satisfaction, teamwork, attendance or conflict.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Workplace Behaviour is important because organizational results are produced through people. Applying its concepts helps managers make more balanced decisions, improve cooperation and create conditions in which employees and teams can perform effectively.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q2. Apply the theoretical framework of Workplace Behaviour to a workplace situation involving individual and group behaviour.

Real-life workplace scenario: A workplace manager examines individual, group and organizational factors before selecting an intervention, instead of assuming that poor performance is caused by attitude alone.

Model Answer

Workplace Behaviour is the systematic study and practical application of knowledge about how people behave as individuals and in groups within organizations. Its purpose is not merely to describe behaviour; it helps managers understand, anticipate and influence workplace outcomes in a responsible manner.

Key explanation / application:

- **Individual level:** Personality, perception, attitudes, values, learning, motivation and individual differences influence how an employee interprets work and responds.
- **Group level:** Roles, norms, communication, leadership, power, conflict, cooperation and team processes influence collective behaviour.
- **Organizational level:** Structure, policies, culture, technology, work design and managerial systems create the wider context in which individuals and groups operate.
- **Outcomes:** Typical outcomes include performance, job satisfaction, engagement, attendance, teamwork, quality, innovation, conflict and employee well-being.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: collect evidence at all three levels, identify the factors that are actually influencing behaviour, and choose interventions that match the cause. For low motivation, this may mean feedback and recognition; for team conflict, role clarification and communication; for organizational confusion, clearer policies and priorities.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A newly formed project team is missing milestones. At the individual level, one member may lack confidence in a new tool; at the group level, roles may be unclear and communication irregular; at the organizational level, priorities may change frequently. A manager who applies Workplace Behaviour concepts can address training, role clarity, meeting norms and priority communication rather than attributing the problem to 'poor attitude' alone.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

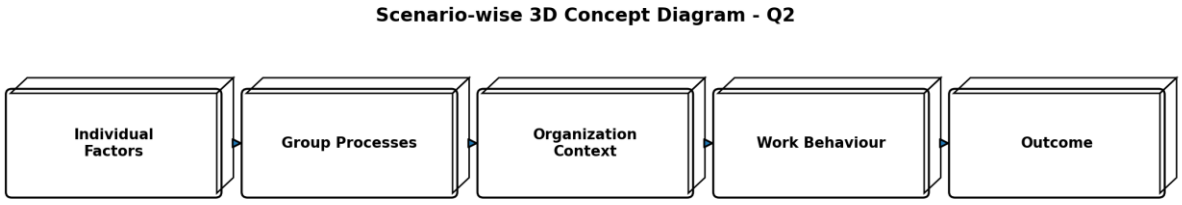


Figure Q2: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Outcome

Individual Factors	Group Processes	Organizational Context	Work Behaviour	Performance & Satisfaction

Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organizational Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Extended discussion: Workplace Behaviour is multidisciplinary. It draws on psychology for individual processes, social psychology and sociology for group processes, and management theory for organizational

systems. Its practical strength is the ability to connect these levels. A performance problem that appears to be an individual issue may actually be caused by unclear team roles or an organizational policy. Conversely, a broad organizational problem may sometimes be improved through individual coaching or skill development. Managers should therefore diagnose before intervening and should distinguish observable facts from assumptions about employees.

Additional mini-case: A new employee misses two deadlines. Instead of immediately labelling the employee as careless, the manager checks the work process and finds that the employee did not receive access to a required system and was unsure whom to contact. Providing access, role clarity and a peer mentor solves the problem. This illustrates why individual, group and organizational factors should be considered together.

Exam-writing point: A strong answer should move from concept to level-wise application and then to workplace outcomes such as performance, satisfaction, teamwork, attendance or conflict.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Workplace Behaviour is important because organizational results are produced through people. Applying its concepts helps managers make more balanced decisions, improve cooperation and create conditions in which employees and teams can perform effectively.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q3. Apply the S-O-B-C model to a suitable workplace situation covering all four components.

Real-life workplace scenario: A manager introduces a new workplace rule or reward. Employees interpret it differently, show observable behaviour, and experience consequences that influence future behaviour.

Model Answer

The S-O-B-C framework is a practical way of connecting a workplace event with the employee's internal interpretation, the behaviour that follows, and the consequence produced by that behaviour. It prevents a manager from assuming that the same event will automatically produce the same response in every employee.

Key explanation / application:

- **Stimulus (S):** An event or condition in the work environment that attracts attention, such as a new rule, reward, deadline, supervisor instruction, workload change or recognition scheme.
- **Organism (O):** The employee's internal state and interpretation: perception, attitudes, expectations, values, personality, prior experience and motivation.
- **Behaviour (B):** The observable response, for example participation, effort, punctuality, cooperation, resistance, absenteeism or task performance.
- **Consequence (C):** What follows the behaviour: recognition, feedback, reward, relief from supervision, correction, dissatisfaction, improved results or other outcomes that can influence future behaviour.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: the manager should not stop at the visible behaviour. If participation is low, the manager should examine the stimulus and the employee's interpretation. Poor communication, perceived unfairness or fear of failure can alter the organism stage. Correcting the stimulus, clarifying expectations and using appropriate consequences can therefore change behaviour more effectively than blame.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A software company announces public appreciation for teams that close critical customer issues within the agreed service time. The announcement is the stimulus. A developer who views the scheme as fair and achievable feels motivated (organism), coordinates faster with the testing team and completes the fix on time (behaviour). Appreciation from the project manager and positive customer feedback become the consequence. If this consequence is valued, timely collaborative behaviour is more likely to recur.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

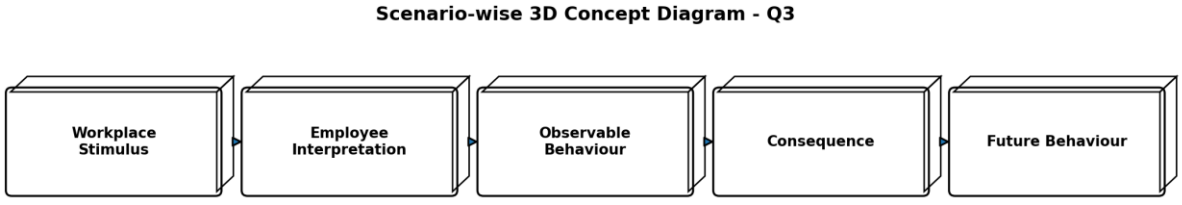


Figure Q3: Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Workplace Stimulus	Employee Interpretation / Organism	Observable Behaviour	Consequence	Future Behaviour

Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation / Organism → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Extended discussion: The value of S-O-B-C is that it separates the external event from the employee's internal interpretation. Two employees can receive the same stimulus but respond differently because their expectations, experience, attitudes and perceptions differ. For this reason, a manager should verify the Organism stage through discussion, observation and feedback rather than assuming the cause of behaviour. The Consequence stage is equally important because consequences teach employees what the organization actually values. If desired behaviour is followed by no recognition while undesirable shortcuts are rewarded by faster results, the system may unintentionally reinforce the wrong behaviour.

Additional mini-case: Suppose a department introduces a compulsory daily progress meeting. One employee sees it as useful coordination, while another sees it as unnecessary monitoring. The same stimulus therefore produces different organism responses and may lead to cooperation in one case and resistance in another. A manager can improve the result by explaining the purpose, inviting feedback, keeping the meeting focused and recognizing constructive participation.

Exam-writing point: A complete application answer should explicitly name S, O, B and C, connect them in sequence, and show how the consequence may strengthen or weaken future behaviour. A labelled flow diagram adds clarity.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Thus, S-O-B-C is useful for diagnosing workplace behaviour systematically. It links environment, individual interpretation, action and outcome and helps a manager select a more evidence-based intervention.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q4. Apply any two models of Workplace Behaviour to a suitable managerial situation.

Real-life workplace scenario: During a production outage, the manager first gives clear directions; after recovery, the team jointly reviews causes and preventive actions. Different WB models suit different stages.

Model Answer

Models of Workplace Behaviour describe different assumptions managers make about employees and the type of managerial climate created from those assumptions. The commonly discussed models are autocratic, custodial, supportive and collegial. No model should be treated as universally best; its usefulness depends on the work, people and context.

Key explanation / application:

- **Autocratic:** Based on managerial power and authority. Employees are expected to obey directions. It may provide speed and control in emergencies but can create dependence and low involvement.
- **Custodial:** Based on economic resources, benefits and security. Employees may feel secure, but security alone does not necessarily create high motivation or ownership.
- **Supportive:** Based on leadership, encouragement and conditions that help employees perform. It aims at participation, recognition, motivation and improved job performance.
- **Collegial:** Based on partnership, teamwork, shared responsibility and self-discipline. It suits competent teams where collaboration and professional responsibility are important.

Application to the given workplace situation: Application to management: a manager should diagnose urgency, employee competence, need for participation and the degree of interdependence. Supportive and collegial practices are particularly useful when innovation, learning and commitment are required, whereas directive authority may be necessary for immediate safety or crisis control.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: During a production outage, a team leader may temporarily use clear autocratic direction because rapid coordinated action is required. After service is restored, the same leader may shift to a supportive or collegial approach during the root-cause review, inviting engineers to contribute ideas and jointly own preventive actions.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

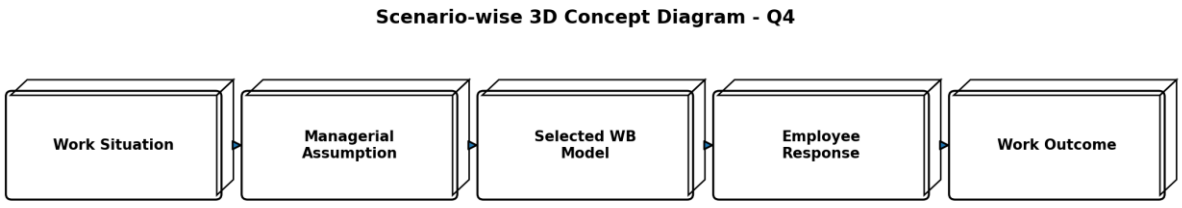


Figure Q4: Work Situation → Managerial Assumption → Selected WB Model → Employee Response → Work Outcome

Managerial Assumption	Chosen WB Model	Leadership Practice	Employee Response	Workplace Outcome

Managerial Assumption → Chosen WB Model → Leadership Practice → Employee Response → Workplace Outcome

Extended discussion: These models can also be viewed as an evolution in managerial assumptions—from dependence on authority, to dependence on organizational security, to support for performance, and finally to partnership and self-discipline. Modern organizations may display elements of more than one model at the same time. For example, safety rules may require non-negotiable authority, compensation policies may

provide custodial security, team leaders may use supportive coaching, and professional project teams may work collegially. Therefore, application requires situational judgment rather than simply naming a model.

Additional mini-case: In a college technical-event committee, the coordinator may initially set mandatory deadlines and responsibilities. Once roles are understood, the coordinator can shift toward a collegial approach by allowing members to plan execution jointly and hold one another accountable. This combination can provide clarity without suppressing initiative.

Exam-writing point: For five marks, state the relevant model(s), mention the managerial basis/assumption, apply them to the situation and end with the likely employee response or organizational outcome.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: The models are best used as lenses for managerial choice. Effective managers understand the assumptions behind each model and deliberately create a climate appropriate to the situation rather than applying one model mechanically.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q5. A team shows low participation after a change in work rules. Apply the S-O-B-C model to this situation considering possible causes and consequences.

Real-life workplace scenario: After a company changes reporting rules without consultation, team participation falls. The manager uses S-O-B-C to trace the rule change, employee perception, withdrawal behaviour and its consequences.

Model Answer

The S-O-B-C framework is a practical way of connecting a workplace event with the employee's internal interpretation, the behaviour that follows, and the consequence produced by that behaviour. It prevents a manager from assuming that the same event will automatically produce the same response in every employee.

Key explanation / application:

- **Stimulus (S):** An event or condition in the work environment that attracts attention, such as a new rule, reward, deadline, supervisor instruction, workload change or recognition scheme.
- **Organism (O):** The employee's internal state and interpretation: perception, attitudes, expectations, values, personality, prior experience and motivation.
- **Behaviour (B):** The observable response, for example participation, effort, punctuality, cooperation, resistance, absenteeism or task performance.
- **Consequence (C):** What follows the behaviour: recognition, feedback, reward, relief from supervision, correction, dissatisfaction, improved results or other outcomes that can influence future behaviour.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: the manager should not stop at the visible behaviour. If participation is low, the manager should examine the stimulus and the employee's interpretation. Poor communication, perceived unfairness or fear of failure can alter the organism stage. Correcting the stimulus, clarifying expectations and using appropriate consequences can therefore change behaviour more effectively than blame.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A software company announces public appreciation for teams that close critical customer issues within the agreed service time. The announcement is the stimulus. A developer who views the scheme as fair and achievable feels motivated (organism), coordinates faster with the testing team and completes the fix on time (behaviour). Appreciation from the project manager and positive customer feedback become the consequence. If this consequence is valued, timely collaborative behaviour is more likely to recur.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

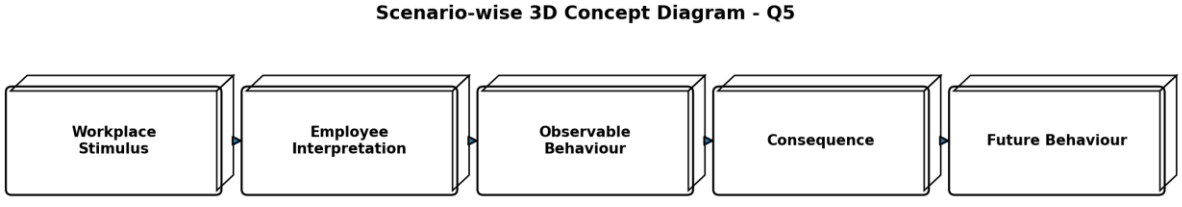


Figure Q5: Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Workplace Stimulus	Employee	Observable Behaviour	Consequence	Future Behaviour

	Interpretation / Organism			

Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation / Organism → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Extended discussion: The value of S-O-B-C is that it separates the external event from the employee's internal interpretation. Two employees can receive the same stimulus but respond differently because their expectations, experience, attitudes and perceptions differ. For this reason, a manager should verify the Organism stage through discussion, observation and feedback rather than assuming the cause of behaviour. The Consequence stage is equally important because consequences teach employees what the organization actually values. If desired behaviour is followed by no recognition while undesirable shortcuts are rewarded by faster results, the system may unintentionally reinforce the wrong behaviour.

Additional mini-case: Suppose a department introduces a compulsory daily progress meeting. One employee sees it as useful coordination, while another sees it as unnecessary monitoring. The same stimulus therefore produces different organism responses and may lead to cooperation in one case and resistance in another. A manager can improve the result by explaining the purpose, inviting feedback, keeping the meeting focused and recognizing constructive participation.

Exam-writing point: A complete application answer should explicitly name S, O, B and C, connect them in sequence, and show how the consequence may strengthen or weaken future behaviour. A labelled flow diagram adds clarity.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Thus, S-O-B-C is useful for diagnosing workplace behaviour systematically. It links environment, individual interpretation, action and outcome and helps a manager select a more evidence-based intervention.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q6. Apply the scope of Workplace Behaviour to an organization facing poor coordination and declining employee involvement.

Real-life workplace scenario: A workplace manager examines individual, group and organizational factors before selecting an intervention, instead of assuming that poor performance is caused by attitude alone.

Model Answer

Workplace Behaviour is the systematic study and practical application of knowledge about how people behave as individuals and in groups within organizations. Its purpose is not merely to describe behaviour; it helps managers understand, anticipate and influence workplace outcomes in a responsible manner.

Key explanation / application:

- **Individual level:** Personality, perception, attitudes, values, learning, motivation and individual differences influence how an employee interprets work and responds.
- **Group level:** Roles, norms, communication, leadership, power, conflict, cooperation and team processes influence collective behaviour.
- **Organizational level:** Structure, policies, culture, technology, work design and managerial systems create the wider context in which individuals and groups operate.
- **Outcomes:** Typical outcomes include performance, job satisfaction, engagement, attendance, teamwork, quality, innovation, conflict and employee well-being.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: collect evidence at all three levels, identify the factors that are actually influencing behaviour, and choose interventions that match the cause. For low motivation, this may mean feedback and recognition; for team conflict, role clarification and communication; for organizational confusion, clearer policies and priorities.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A newly formed project team is missing milestones. At the individual level, one member may lack confidence in a new tool; at the group level, roles may be unclear and communication irregular; at the organizational level, priorities may change frequently. A manager who applies Workplace Behaviour concepts can address training, role clarity, meeting norms and priority communication rather than attributing the problem to 'poor attitude' alone.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

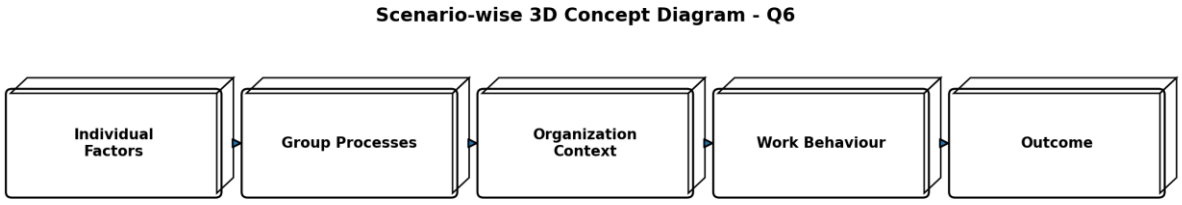


Figure Q6: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Outcome

Individual Factors	Group Processes	Organizational Context	Work Behaviour	Performance & Satisfaction

Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organizational Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Extended discussion: Workplace Behaviour is multidisciplinary. It draws on psychology for individual processes, social psychology and sociology for group processes, and management theory for organizational

systems. Its practical strength is the ability to connect these levels. A performance problem that appears to be an individual issue may actually be caused by unclear team roles or an organizational policy. Conversely, a broad organizational problem may sometimes be improved through individual coaching or skill development. Managers should therefore diagnose before intervening and should distinguish observable facts from assumptions about employees.

Additional mini-case: A new employee misses two deadlines. Instead of immediately labelling the employee as careless, the manager checks the work process and finds that the employee did not receive access to a required system and was unsure whom to contact. Providing access, role clarity and a peer mentor solves the problem. This illustrates why individual, group and organizational factors should be considered together.

Exam-writing point: A strong answer should move from concept to level-wise application and then to workplace outcomes such as performance, satisfaction, teamwork, attendance or conflict.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Workplace Behaviour is important because organizational results are produced through people. Applying its concepts helps managers make more balanced decisions, improve cooperation and create conditions in which employees and teams can perform effectively.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q7. Apply the concept of Workplace Behaviour to a situation involving employees, managers and the organization.

Real-life workplace scenario: A workplace manager examines individual, group and organizational factors before selecting an intervention, instead of assuming that poor performance is caused by attitude alone.

Model Answer

Workplace Behaviour is the systematic study and practical application of knowledge about how people behave as individuals and in groups within organizations. Its purpose is not merely to describe behaviour; it helps managers understand, anticipate and influence workplace outcomes in a responsible manner.

Key explanation / application:

- **Individual level:** Personality, perception, attitudes, values, learning, motivation and individual differences influence how an employee interprets work and responds.
- **Group level:** Roles, norms, communication, leadership, power, conflict, cooperation and team processes influence collective behaviour.
- **Organizational level:** Structure, policies, culture, technology, work design and managerial systems create the wider context in which individuals and groups operate.
- **Outcomes:** Typical outcomes include performance, job satisfaction, engagement, attendance, teamwork, quality, innovation, conflict and employee well-being.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: collect evidence at all three levels, identify the factors that are actually influencing behaviour, and choose interventions that match the cause. For low motivation, this may mean feedback and recognition; for team conflict, role clarification and communication; for organizational confusion, clearer policies and priorities.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A newly formed project team is missing milestones. At the individual level, one member may lack confidence in a new tool; at the group level, roles may be unclear and communication irregular; at the organizational level, priorities may change frequently. A manager who applies Workplace Behaviour concepts can address training, role clarity, meeting norms and priority communication rather than attributing the problem to 'poor attitude' alone.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

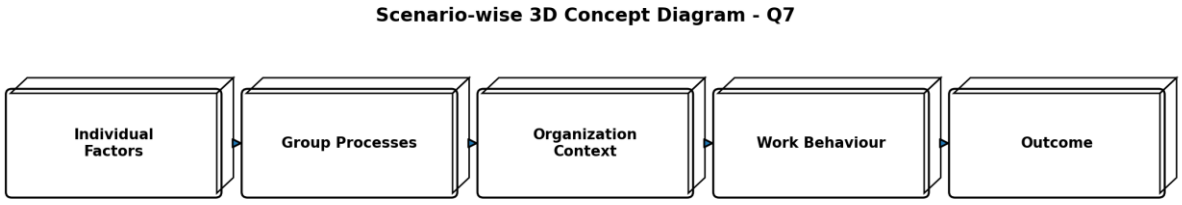


Figure Q7: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Outcome

Individual Factors	Group Processes	Organizational Context	Work Behaviour	Performance & Satisfaction

Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organizational Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Extended discussion: Workplace Behaviour is multidisciplinary. It draws on psychology for individual processes, social psychology and sociology for group processes, and management theory for organizational

systems. Its practical strength is the ability to connect these levels. A performance problem that appears to be an individual issue may actually be caused by unclear team roles or an organizational policy. Conversely, a broad organizational problem may sometimes be improved through individual coaching or skill development. Managers should therefore diagnose before intervening and should distinguish observable facts from assumptions about employees.

Additional mini-case: A new employee misses two deadlines. Instead of immediately labelling the employee as careless, the manager checks the work process and finds that the employee did not receive access to a required system and was unsure whom to contact. Providing access, role clarity and a peer mentor solves the problem. This illustrates why individual, group and organizational factors should be considered together.

Exam-writing point: A strong answer should move from concept to level-wise application and then to workplace outcomes such as performance, satisfaction, teamwork, attendance or conflict.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Workplace Behaviour is important because organizational results are produced through people. Applying its concepts helps managers make more balanced decisions, improve cooperation and create conditions in which employees and teams can perform effectively.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q8. Apply the major models of Workplace Behaviour to a workplace situation involving different assumptions about employees.

Real-life workplace scenario: During a production outage, the manager first gives clear directions; after recovery, the team jointly reviews causes and preventive actions. Different WB models suit different stages.

Model Answer

Models of Workplace Behaviour describe different assumptions managers make about employees and the type of managerial climate created from those assumptions. The commonly discussed models are autocratic, custodial, supportive and collegial. No model should be treated as universally best; its usefulness depends on the work, people and context.

Key explanation / application:

- **Autocratic:** Based on managerial power and authority. Employees are expected to obey directions. It may provide speed and control in emergencies but can create dependence and low involvement.
- **Custodial:** Based on economic resources, benefits and security. Employees may feel secure, but security alone does not necessarily create high motivation or ownership.
- **Supportive:** Based on leadership, encouragement and conditions that help employees perform. It aims at participation, recognition, motivation and improved job performance.
- **Collegial:** Based on partnership, teamwork, shared responsibility and self-discipline. It suits competent teams where collaboration and professional responsibility are important.

Application to the given workplace situation: Application to management: a manager should diagnose urgency, employee competence, need for participation and the degree of interdependence. Supportive and collegial practices are particularly useful when innovation, learning and commitment are required, whereas directive authority may be necessary for immediate safety or crisis control.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: During a production outage, a team leader may temporarily use clear autocratic direction because rapid coordinated action is required. After service is restored, the same leader may shift to a supportive or collegial approach during the root-cause review, inviting engineers to contribute ideas and jointly own preventive actions.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

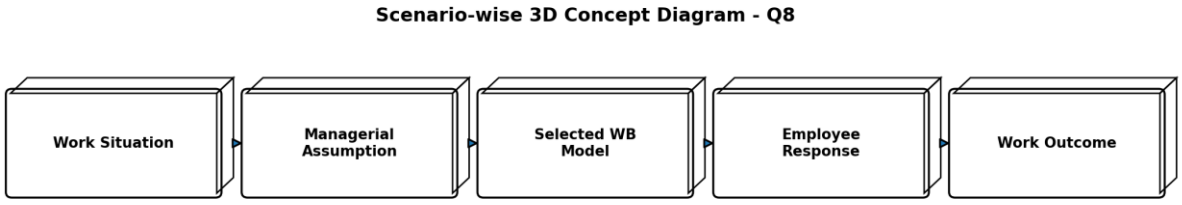


Figure Q8: Work Situation → Managerial Assumption → Selected WB Model → Employee Response → Work Outcome

Managerial Assumption	Chosen WB Model	Leadership Practice	Employee Response	Workplace Outcome

Managerial Assumption → Chosen WB Model → Leadership Practice → Employee Response → Workplace Outcome

Extended discussion: These models can also be viewed as an evolution in managerial assumptions—from dependence on authority, to dependence on organizational security, to support for performance, and finally to partnership and self-discipline. Modern organizations may display elements of more than one model at the

same time. For example, safety rules may require non-negotiable authority, compensation policies may provide custodial security, team leaders may use supportive coaching, and professional project teams may work collegially. Therefore, application requires situational judgment rather than simply naming a model.

Additional mini-case: In a college technical-event committee, the coordinator may initially set mandatory deadlines and responsibilities. Once roles are understood, the coordinator can shift toward a collegial approach by allowing members to plan execution jointly and hold one another accountable. This combination can provide clarity without suppressing initiative.

Exam-writing point: For five marks, state the relevant model(s), mention the managerial basis/assumption, apply them to the situation and end with the likely employee response or organizational outcome.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: The models are best used as lenses for managerial choice. Effective managers understand the assumptions behind each model and deliberately create a climate appropriate to the situation rather than applying one model mechanically.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q9. A manager introduces recognition for timely project completion. Apply the S-O-B-C model to this situation.

Real-life workplace scenario: An IT project manager publicly recognizes teams that complete milestones on time. Employees value the recognition, coordinate more actively and repeat timely completion.

Model Answer

The S-O-B-C framework is a practical way of connecting a workplace event with the employee's internal interpretation, the behaviour that follows, and the consequence produced by that behaviour. It prevents a manager from assuming that the same event will automatically produce the same response in every employee.

Key explanation / application:

- **Stimulus (S):** An event or condition in the work environment that attracts attention, such as a new rule, reward, deadline, supervisor instruction, workload change or recognition scheme.
- **Organism (O):** The employee's internal state and interpretation: perception, attitudes, expectations, values, personality, prior experience and motivation.
- **Behaviour (B):** The observable response, for example participation, effort, punctuality, cooperation, resistance, absenteeism or task performance.
- **Consequence (C):** What follows the behaviour: recognition, feedback, reward, relief from supervision, correction, dissatisfaction, improved results or other outcomes that can influence future behaviour.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: the manager should not stop at the visible behaviour. If participation is low, the manager should examine the stimulus and the employee's interpretation. Poor communication, perceived unfairness or fear of failure can alter the organism stage. Correcting the stimulus, clarifying expectations and using appropriate consequences can therefore change behaviour more effectively than blame.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A software company announces public appreciation for teams that close critical customer issues within the agreed service time. The announcement is the stimulus. A developer who views the scheme as fair and achievable feels motivated (organism), coordinates faster with the testing team and completes the fix on time (behaviour). Appreciation from the project manager and positive customer feedback become the consequence. If this consequence is valued, timely collaborative behaviour is more likely to recur.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

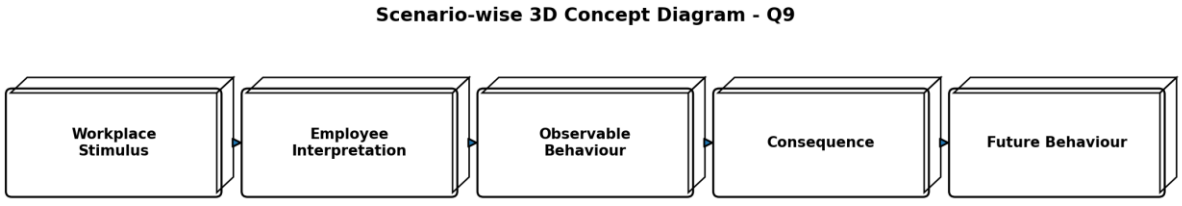


Figure Q9: Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Workplace Stimulus	Employee Interpretation /	Observable Behaviour	Consequence	Future Behaviour

	Organism			

Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation / Organism → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Extended discussion: The value of S-O-B-C is that it separates the external event from the employee's internal interpretation. Two employees can receive the same stimulus but respond differently because their expectations, experience, attitudes and perceptions differ. For this reason, a manager should verify the Organism stage through discussion, observation and feedback rather than assuming the cause of behaviour. The Consequence stage is equally important because consequences teach employees what the organization actually values. If desired behaviour is followed by no recognition while undesirable shortcuts are rewarded by faster results, the system may unintentionally reinforce the wrong behaviour.

Additional mini-case: Suppose a department introduces a compulsory daily progress meeting. One employee sees it as useful coordination, while another sees it as unnecessary monitoring. The same stimulus therefore produces different organism responses and may lead to cooperation in one case and resistance in another. A manager can improve the result by explaining the purpose, inviting feedback, keeping the meeting focused and recognizing constructive participation.

Exam-writing point: A complete application answer should explicitly name S, O, B and C, connect them in sequence, and show how the consequence may strengthen or weaken future behaviour. A labelled flow diagram adds clarity.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Thus, S-O-B-C is useful for diagnosing workplace behaviour systematically. It links environment, individual interpretation, action and outcome and helps a manager select a more evidence-based intervention.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q10. Apply Workplace Behaviour concepts to improve teamwork in a newly formed project group.

Real-life workplace scenario: A newly formed project team misses milestones because roles are unclear and communication is irregular. The manager applies WB concepts to clarify roles, norms and coordination.

Model Answer

Workplace Behaviour is the systematic study and practical application of knowledge about how people behave as individuals and in groups within organizations. Its purpose is not merely to describe behaviour; it helps managers understand, anticipate and influence workplace outcomes in a responsible manner.

Key explanation / application:

- **Individual level:** Personality, perception, attitudes, values, learning, motivation and individual differences influence how an employee interprets work and responds.
- **Group level:** Roles, norms, communication, leadership, power, conflict, cooperation and team processes influence collective behaviour.
- **Organizational level:** Structure, policies, culture, technology, work design and managerial systems create the wider context in which individuals and groups operate.
- **Outcomes:** Typical outcomes include performance, job satisfaction, engagement, attendance, teamwork, quality, innovation, conflict and employee well-being.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: collect evidence at all three levels, identify the factors that are actually influencing behaviour, and choose interventions that match the cause. For low motivation, this may mean feedback and recognition; for team conflict, role clarification and communication; for organizational confusion, clearer policies and priorities.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A newly formed project team is missing milestones. At the individual level, one member may lack confidence in a new tool; at the group level, roles may be unclear and communication irregular; at the organizational level, priorities may change frequently. A manager who applies Workplace Behaviour concepts can address training, role clarity, meeting norms and priority communication rather than attributing the problem to 'poor attitude' alone.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

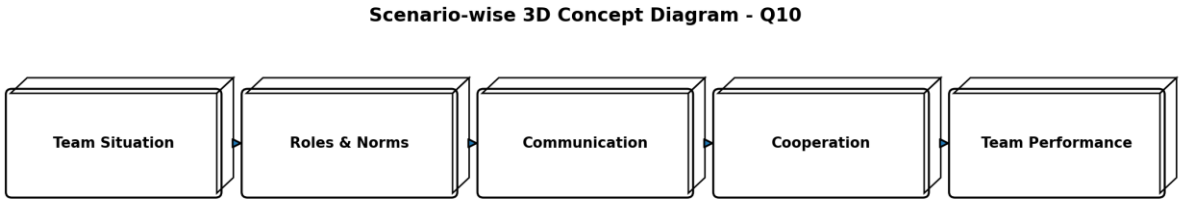


Figure Q10: Team Situation → Roles & Norms → Communication → Cooperation → Team Performance

Individual Factors	Group Processes	Organizational Context	Work Behaviour	Performance & Satisfaction

Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organizational Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Extended discussion: Workplace Behaviour is multidisciplinary. It draws on psychology for individual processes, social psychology and sociology for group processes, and management theory for organizational

systems. Its practical strength is the ability to connect these levels. A performance problem that appears to be an individual issue may actually be caused by unclear team roles or an organizational policy. Conversely, a broad organizational problem may sometimes be improved through individual coaching or skill development. Managers should therefore diagnose before intervening and should distinguish observable facts from assumptions about employees.

Additional mini-case: A new employee misses two deadlines. Instead of immediately labelling the employee as careless, the manager checks the work process and finds that the employee did not receive access to a required system and was unsure whom to contact. Providing access, role clarity and a peer mentor solves the problem. This illustrates why individual, group and organizational factors should be considered together.

Exam-writing point: A strong answer should move from concept to level-wise application and then to workplace outcomes such as performance, satisfaction, teamwork, attendance or conflict.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Workplace Behaviour is important because organizational results are produced through people. Applying its concepts helps managers make more balanced decisions, improve cooperation and create conditions in which employees and teams can perform effectively.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q11. Apply individual-level Workplace Behaviour concepts to an employee showing low motivation.

Real-life workplace scenario: A capable employee shows low motivation after repeated effort receives little feedback. The manager examines attitudes, perception, needs and recognition.

Model Answer

Workplace Behaviour is the systematic study and practical application of knowledge about how people behave as individuals and in groups within organizations. Its purpose is not merely to describe behaviour; it helps managers understand, anticipate and influence workplace outcomes in a responsible manner.

Key explanation / application:

- **Individual level:** Personality, perception, attitudes, values, learning, motivation and individual differences influence how an employee interprets work and responds.
- **Group level:** Roles, norms, communication, leadership, power, conflict, cooperation and team processes influence collective behaviour.
- **Organizational level:** Structure, policies, culture, technology, work design and managerial systems create the wider context in which individuals and groups operate.
- **Outcomes:** Typical outcomes include performance, job satisfaction, engagement, attendance, teamwork, quality, innovation, conflict and employee well-being.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: collect evidence at all three levels, identify the factors that are actually influencing behaviour, and choose interventions that match the cause. For low motivation, this may mean feedback and recognition; for team conflict, role clarification and communication; for organizational confusion, clearer policies and priorities.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A newly formed project team is missing milestones. At the individual level, one member may lack confidence in a new tool; at the group level, roles may be unclear and communication irregular; at the organizational level, priorities may change frequently. A manager who applies Workplace Behaviour concepts can address training, role clarity, meeting norms and priority communication rather than attributing the problem to 'poor attitude' alone.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

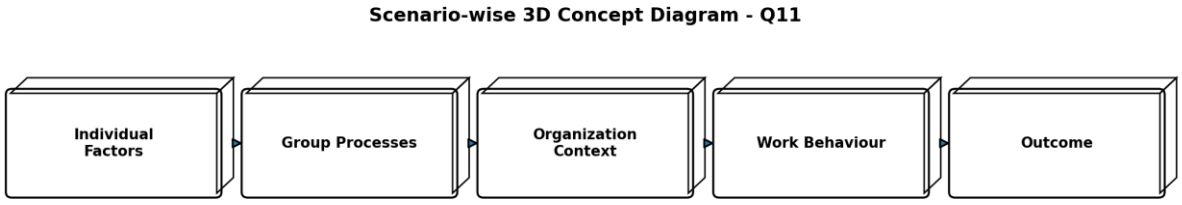


Figure Q11: Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organization Context → Work Behaviour → Outcome

Individual Factors	Group Processes	Organizational Context	Work Behaviour	Performance & Satisfaction

Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organizational Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Extended discussion: Workplace Behaviour is multidisciplinary. It draws on psychology for individual processes, social psychology and sociology for group processes, and management theory for organizational

systems. Its practical strength is the ability to connect these levels. A performance problem that appears to be an individual issue may actually be caused by unclear team roles or an organizational policy. Conversely, a broad organizational problem may sometimes be improved through individual coaching or skill development. Managers should therefore diagnose before intervening and should distinguish observable facts from assumptions about employees.

Additional mini-case: A new employee misses two deadlines. Instead of immediately labelling the employee as careless, the manager checks the work process and finds that the employee did not receive access to a required system and was unsure whom to contact. Providing access, role clarity and a peer mentor solves the problem. This illustrates why individual, group and organizational factors should be considered together.

Exam-writing point: A strong answer should move from concept to level-wise application and then to workplace outcomes such as performance, satisfaction, teamwork, attendance or conflict.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Workplace Behaviour is important because organizational results are produced through people. Applying its concepts helps managers make more balanced decisions, improve cooperation and create conditions in which employees and teams can perform effectively.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q12. Apply group-level Workplace Behaviour concepts to resolve conflict between two teams.

Real-life workplace scenario: Development and testing teams blame each other for delays. Shared goals, role clarification and structured communication are used to reduce inter-group conflict.

Model Answer

Workplace Behaviour is the systematic study and practical application of knowledge about how people behave as individuals and in groups within organizations. Its purpose is not merely to describe behaviour; it helps managers understand, anticipate and influence workplace outcomes in a responsible manner.

Key explanation / application:

- **Individual level:** Personality, perception, attitudes, values, learning, motivation and individual differences influence how an employee interprets work and responds.
- **Group level:** Roles, norms, communication, leadership, power, conflict, cooperation and team processes influence collective behaviour.
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- **Outcomes:** Typical outcomes include performance, job satisfaction, engagement, attendance, teamwork, quality, innovation, conflict and employee well-being.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: collect evidence at all three levels, identify the factors that are actually influencing behaviour, and choose interventions that match the cause. For low motivation, this may mean feedback and recognition; for team conflict, role clarification and communication; for organizational confusion, clearer policies and priorities.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A newly formed project team is missing milestones. At the individual level, one member may lack confidence in a new tool; at the group level, roles may be unclear and communication irregular; at the organizational level, priorities may change frequently. A manager who applies Workplace Behaviour concepts can address training, role clarity, meeting norms and priority communication rather than attributing the problem to 'poor attitude' alone.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

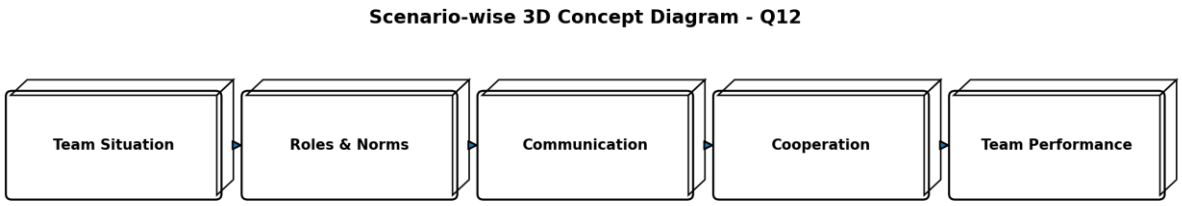


Figure Q12: Team Situation → Roles & Norms → Communication → Cooperation → Team Performance

Individual Factors	Group Processes	Organizational Context	Work Behaviour	Performance & Satisfaction

Individual Factors → Group Processes → Organizational Context → Work Behaviour → Performance & Satisfaction

Extended discussion: Workplace Behaviour is multidisciplinary. It draws on psychology for individual processes, social psychology and sociology for group processes, and management theory for organizational systems. Its practical strength is the ability to connect these levels. A performance problem that appears to

be an individual issue may actually be caused by unclear team roles or an organizational policy. Conversely, a broad organizational problem may sometimes be improved through individual coaching or skill development. Managers should therefore diagnose before intervening and should distinguish observable facts from assumptions about employees.

Additional mini-case: A new employee misses two deadlines. Instead of immediately labelling the employee as careless, the manager checks the work process and finds that the employee did not receive access to a required system and was unsure whom to contact. Providing access, role clarity and a peer mentor solves the problem. This illustrates why individual, group and organizational factors should be considered together.

Exam-writing point: A strong answer should move from concept to level-wise application and then to workplace outcomes such as performance, satisfaction, teamwork, attendance or conflict.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Workplace Behaviour is important because organizational results are produced through people. Applying its concepts helps managers make more balanced decisions, improve cooperation and create conditions in which employees and teams can perform effectively.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q13. Apply the supportive model of Workplace Behaviour to improve employee involvement.

Real-life workplace scenario: In a software team with declining involvement, the project manager shifts from close control to coaching, feedback, recognition and participation in decisions.

Model Answer

Models of Workplace Behaviour describe different assumptions managers make about employees and the type of managerial climate created from those assumptions. The commonly discussed models are autocratic, custodial, supportive and collegial. No model should be treated as universally best; its usefulness depends on the work, people and context.

Key explanation / application:

- **Autocratic:** Based on managerial power and authority. Employees are expected to obey directions. It may provide speed and control in emergencies but can create dependence and low involvement.
- **Custodial:** Based on economic resources, benefits and security. Employees may feel secure, but security alone does not necessarily create high motivation or ownership.
- **Supportive:** Based on leadership, encouragement and conditions that help employees perform. It aims at participation, recognition, motivation and improved job performance.
- **Collegial:** Based on partnership, teamwork, shared responsibility and self-discipline. It suits competent teams where collaboration and professional responsibility are important.

Application to the given workplace situation: Application to management: a manager should diagnose urgency, employee competence, need for participation and the degree of interdependence. Supportive and collegial practices are particularly useful when innovation, learning and commitment are required, whereas directive authority may be necessary for immediate safety or crisis control.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: During a production outage, a team leader may temporarily use clear autocratic direction because rapid coordinated action is required. After service is restored, the same leader may shift to a supportive or collegial approach during the root-cause review, inviting engineers to contribute ideas and jointly own preventive actions.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

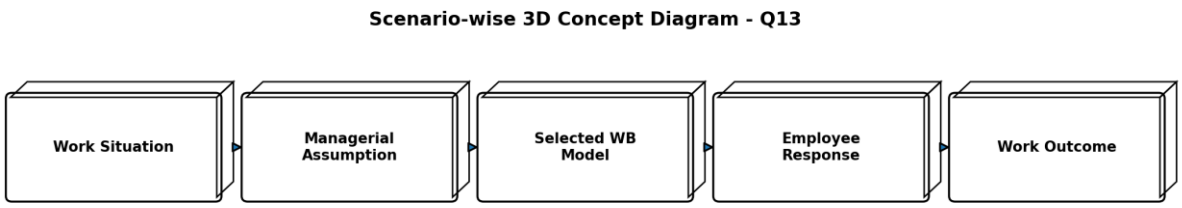


Figure Q13: Work Situation → Managerial Assumption → Selected WB Model → Employee Response → Work Outcome

Managerial Assumption	Chosen WB Model	Leadership Practice	Employee Response	Workplace Outcome

Managerial Assumption → Chosen WB Model → Leadership Practice → Employee Response → Workplace Outcome

Extended discussion: These models can also be viewed as an evolution in managerial assumptions—from dependence on authority, to dependence on organizational security, to support for performance, and finally to partnership and self-discipline. Modern organizations may display elements of more than one model at the same time. For example, safety rules may require non-negotiable authority, compensation policies may

provide custodial security, team leaders may use supportive coaching, and professional project teams may work collegially. Therefore, application requires situational judgment rather than simply naming a model.

Additional mini-case: In a college technical-event committee, the coordinator may initially set mandatory deadlines and responsibilities. Once roles are understood, the coordinator can shift toward a collegial approach by allowing members to plan execution jointly and hold one another accountable. This combination can provide clarity without suppressing initiative.

Exam-writing point: For five marks, state the relevant model(s), mention the managerial basis/assumption, apply them to the situation and end with the likely employee response or organizational outcome.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: The models are best used as lenses for managerial choice. Effective managers understand the assumptions behind each model and deliberately create a climate appropriate to the situation rather than applying one model mechanically.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q14. Apply the collegial model of Workplace Behaviour to a self-managed technical team.

Real-life workplace scenario: A self-managed product team shares planning, peer review and responsibility. The manager acts as a facilitator while members practise partnership and self-discipline.

Model Answer

Models of Workplace Behaviour describe different assumptions managers make about employees and the type of managerial climate created from those assumptions. The commonly discussed models are autocratic, custodial, supportive and collegial. No model should be treated as universally best; its usefulness depends on the work, people and context.

Key explanation / application:

- **Autocratic:** Based on managerial power and authority. Employees are expected to obey directions. It may provide speed and control in emergencies but can create dependence and low involvement.
- **Custodial:** Based on economic resources, benefits and security. Employees may feel secure, but security alone does not necessarily create high motivation or ownership.
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Application to the given workplace situation: Application to management: a manager should diagnose urgency, employee competence, need for participation and the degree of interdependence. Supportive and collegial practices are particularly useful when innovation, learning and commitment are required, whereas directive authority may be necessary for immediate safety or crisis control.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: During a production outage, a team leader may temporarily use clear autocratic direction because rapid coordinated action is required. After service is restored, the same leader may shift to a supportive or collegial approach during the root-cause review, inviting engineers to contribute ideas and jointly own preventive actions.

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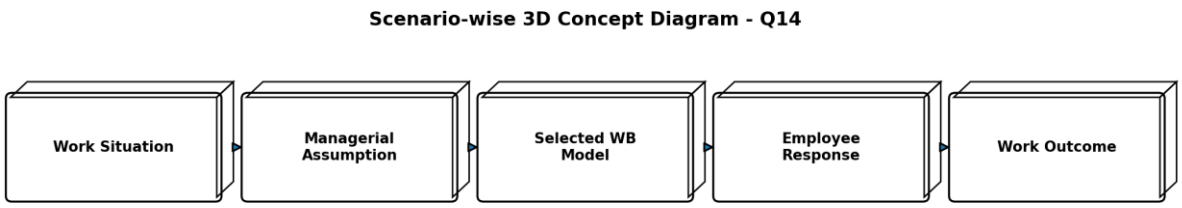


Figure Q14: Work Situation → Managerial Assumption → Selected WB Model → Employee Response → Work Outcome

Managerial Assumption	Chosen WB Model	Leadership Practice	Employee Response	Workplace Outcome

Managerial Assumption → Chosen WB Model → Leadership Practice → Employee Response → Workplace Outcome

Extended discussion: These models can also be viewed as an evolution in managerial assumptions—from dependence on authority, to dependence on organizational security, to support for performance, and finally to partnership and self-discipline. Modern organizations may display elements of more than one model at the same time. For example, safety rules may require non-negotiable authority, compensation policies may

provide custodial security, team leaders may use supportive coaching, and professional project teams may work collegially. Therefore, application requires situational judgment rather than simply naming a model.

Additional mini-case: In a college technical-event committee, the coordinator may initially set mandatory deadlines and responsibilities. Once roles are understood, the coordinator can shift toward a collegial approach by allowing members to plan execution jointly and hold one another accountable. This combination can provide clarity without suppressing initiative.

Exam-writing point: For five marks, state the relevant model(s), mention the managerial basis/assumption, apply them to the situation and end with the likely employee response or organizational outcome.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: The models are best used as lenses for managerial choice. Effective managers understand the assumptions behind each model and deliberately create a climate appropriate to the situation rather than applying one model mechanically.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Q15. Apply the S-O-B-C model to improve punctuality in a workplace.

Real-life workplace scenario: A service firm starts monthly recognition for employees who report on time. Employees perceive the rule as fair, punctuality improves, and recognition reinforces the behaviour.

Model Answer

The S-O-B-C framework is a practical way of connecting a workplace event with the employee's internal interpretation, the behaviour that follows, and the consequence produced by that behaviour. It prevents a manager from assuming that the same event will automatically produce the same response in every employee.

Key explanation / application:

- **Stimulus (S):** An event or condition in the work environment that attracts attention, such as a new rule, reward, deadline, supervisor instruction, workload change or recognition scheme.
- **Organism (O):** The employee's internal state and interpretation: perception, attitudes, expectations, values, personality, prior experience and motivation.
- **Behaviour (B):** The observable response, for example participation, effort, punctuality, cooperation, resistance, absenteeism or task performance.
- **Consequence (C):** What follows the behaviour: recognition, feedback, reward, relief from supervision, correction, dissatisfaction, improved results or other outcomes that can influence future behaviour.

Application to the given workplace situation: Managerial application: the manager should not stop at the visible behaviour. If participation is low, the manager should examine the stimulus and the employee's interpretation. Poor communication, perceived unfairness or fear of failure can alter the organism stage. Correcting the stimulus, clarifying expectations and using appropriate consequences can therefore change behaviour more effectively than blame.

Real-life / practical example: Real-life example: A software company announces public appreciation for teams that close critical customer issues within the agreed service time. The announcement is the stimulus. A developer who views the scheme as fair and achievable feels motivated (organism), coordinates faster with the testing team and completes the fix on time (behaviour). Appreciation from the project manager and positive customer feedback become the consequence. If this consequence is valued, timely collaborative behaviour is more likely to recur.

Suggested labelled diagram / flowchart (draw for full presentation):

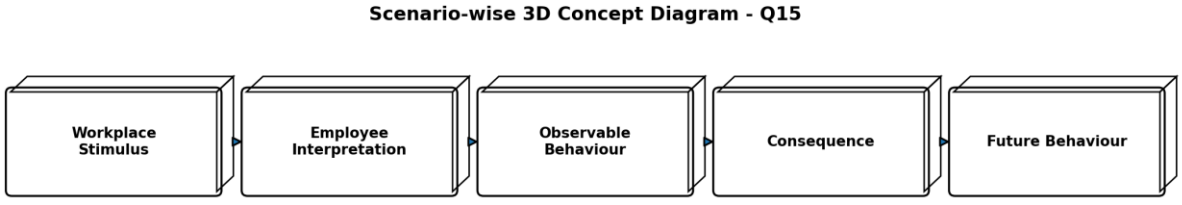


Figure Q15: Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Workplace Stimulus	Employee Interpretation / Organism	Observable Behaviour	Consequence	Future Behaviour

Workplace Stimulus → Employee Interpretation / Organism → Observable Behaviour → Consequence → Future Behaviour

Extended discussion: The value of S-O-B-C is that it separates the external event from the employee's internal interpretation. Two employees can receive the same stimulus but respond differently because their expectations, experience, attitudes and perceptions differ. For this reason, a manager should verify the Organism stage through discussion, observation and feedback rather than assuming the cause of behaviour. The Consequence stage is equally important because consequences teach employees what the organization actually values. If desired behaviour is followed by no recognition while undesirable shortcuts are rewarded by faster results, the system may unintentionally reinforce the wrong behaviour.

Additional mini-case: Suppose a department introduces a compulsory daily progress meeting. One employee sees it as useful coordination, while another sees it as unnecessary monitoring. The same stimulus therefore produces different organism responses and may lead to cooperation in one case and resistance in another. A manager can improve the result by explaining the purpose, inviting feedback, keeping the meeting focused and recognizing constructive participation.

Exam-writing point: A complete application answer should explicitly name S, O, B and C, connect them in sequence, and show how the consequence may strengthen or weaken future behaviour. A labelled flow diagram adds clarity.

Managerial significance: The concept should be used as a practical decision aid. A manager should identify the relevant Behaviour, examine the individual and situational factors, choose an intervention consistent with organizational goals and ethics, and then observe whether the expected behaviour and performance improve.

Conclusion: Thus, S-O-B-C is useful for diagnosing workplace behaviour systematically. It links environment, individual interpretation, action and outcome and helps a manager select a more evidence-based intervention.

Suggested 5-mark coverage: Concept / framework - 1 mark; correct application of key elements - 2 marks; real-life example - 1 mark; diagram / conclusion / managerial relevance - 1 mark.

Reference direction: Use the prescribed Organizational Behaviour texts by Aswathappa, Robbins, Luthans and Robbins/Judge/Vohra for the concept; use Robbins & Coulter and Kaul for managerial application and organizational context.

Prescribed / Suggested References

1. K. Aswathappa, Organizational Behavior. Himalaya Publishing House, 2018.
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